

The Floating Isles



The Floating Isles are islands adrift in a calm sky, in a realm where magic only ever helps: it grows, it heals, it changes one thing into another, and it lets you speak with animals and objects. It never harms. On the home island, the House of the Little Mages sits at the highest point, where young mages learn their first spells, and the city where the families live spreads below. Inside the school grounds lies the Great Garden, the green heart of the whole island. Here nobody loses; you find your way by being clever and kind.



Who's Who and What's What

Places

House of the Little Mages - The school at the highest point of the home island, where young mages learn their first magic.

Lantern Square - The wide square on the home island where the families gather for the Festival of Lights.

The Cloud Bank - A low drift of soft clouds at the island's edge, where some of the lost lanterns are hidden.

The Flower Bed - The second stop, where four flowers must be set in the right order.

The Great Garden - The green heart of the home island, inside the school grounds. The whole adventure crosses it.

The Heart of the Garden - The final stop at the centre of the Great Garden, where the adventure ends with a friend, not a fight.

The High Ledge - A rocky shelf high above the square, where the biggest festival lantern has caught.

The Market Row - The busy row of family stalls on the home island, below the school, where everyone trades on market day.

The Talking Fountain - The third stop, a stone fountain that has gone quiet and sad.

The Vine Gate - The first stop, a gate tied shut by a knot of leaves.

Characters



Pip the New Mage - A kind apprentice on their very first day, whose Change spell muddled the market by accident and who was too shy at first to own up.



The Lonely Sprite - The little sprite of the Heart who sent the garden to sleep, not out of spite but because it wanted a friend.

Creatures

Bridge Tortoise - A patient tortoise who lets travellers cross on her broad shell.

Librarian Owl - A wise owl who loves a good riddle.

Messenger Butterfly - A bright butterfly that carries little messages and the odd free hint.



Mist Cat - A gentle cat made of fog who gives hints.



Nimbo the Cloud-Whale Calf - A small, gentle cloud-whale who gathered the festival lanterns because it was lonely and loved their glow.

Talking Flowers - Flowers that chat in soft little voices when you lean close.

Items

Sky Lantern - A soft paper lantern with a warm little flame that floats up into the sky on festival night.

Words to Know

Change - Turns one object into another, such as a stone into a key.

Grow - Makes plants, bridges and paths grow so nobody is ever stuck.

Light - Reveals what is hidden and calms frightened creatures.

The Festival of Lights - The evening when the families of the Isles send glowing sky lanterns up into the calm sky together.

Voice - Lets you speak with animals and objects, and ask them kindly for help.

The Sleeping Garden: Idea Bank

Improv fuel for when a child goes happily off-script. Pull from these freely; none of it can break the story. Everything here is gentle and helpful, in keeping with the Isles, where magic never harms.

Powers by magic

Light: a firefly eye that lights up clues, a sun-gaze that reads hidden messages, a kind flash that calms a nervous creature, a glowing compass, a curtain of light to hide behind, a guiding beacon, a rainbow bridge.

Grow: a gardener's hand that plants a bridge, a leaping ivy vine, a shield of leaves so nobody is hurt, a speedy seed, a moss trampoline, an umbrella flower for shelter, friendly roots that lend a hand.

Change: a transforming touch (a stone into a key), a mini-and-maxi spell that shrinks or grows things, chameleon colours, a water trick (ice into mist), a wildcard key, a path of stepping stones, a mirror echo.

Voice: animal chat, a whisper to objects (asking what they need), a calming song, a finding echo, a friendly request, a joke-teller that opens grumpy gates, a call for friends.

Items by magic

- **Light:** a lantern of stars, a rainbow magnifying glass, night glasses, a candle that never goes out.
- **Grow:** a jumping seed, an endless watering can, giant gloves, a pocket flowerpot.
- **Change:** a chalk wand, a colour-changing glove, a transforming die, a magic ice cube.
- **Voice:** a talking conch, an animal whistle, a leaf megaphone, a notebook that listens.

Items for anyone

A cloak of courage, a compass of friendship, a jar of glimmer, a map that draws itself, a toy master key, a little bell of hints, a pocket mirror, a notebook of secrets, a bottomless bag, a lucky stone. Each item is used once per adventure and recharges by helping or by solving a puzzle.

Friendly creatures

The **Mist Cat** (gives hints), the **Librarian Owl** (loves riddles), the **Bridge Tortoise** (lets you cross on her shell), **Messenger Butterflies** (carry notes and free hints), the **Talking Flowers** (chat in soft voices), and the **Lonely Sprite** once it has a friend. None of them wishes any harm.

Magical places

An echo cave, a mushroom bridge, a mirror lake, a cloud swing, a library of leaves, a clearing full of fireflies.

Mini-challenges

Follow a trail of petals, find the matching pair of stones, sort sounds in order, answer a guardian's riddle, find the way through a maze of flowers, remember a pattern of stars.

Happy rewards

A star sticker, a little dance, a hug and a thank you, a free hint, a new seed to plant, or all your energy stars back at once. Every reward is something to feel glad about; nothing is ever taken away.

Stories in this world

The Lost Lantern Festival (young). Tonight is the Festival of Lights.

The Market of Mixed-Up Magic (older). It is market day on the home island.

The Sleeping Garden (young). This morning you wake up and the whole island is quiet.

Wits and Wonder

World Book

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.